

## Records show more details on Worcester police

City paid out large settlements on several cases

By Dan Glaun  
GLOBE STAFF

Since the Department of Justice released an explosive report last week on alleged civil rights violations by Worcester police, defenders of the department have argued that the allegations are inaccurate and vague, and that investigators failed to document specific, verifiable cases of officer misconduct.

But a Globe review of federal court records and Worcester financial information shows the city had already set-

tled lawsuits over several of the episodes cited in the report, agreeing to pay plaintiffs hundreds of thousands of dollars.

In some of those settled cases, Worcester police maintained that internal investigations found officers did nothing wrong, although the alleged victims say those inquiries were insufficient.

The Police Department's assertion that its officers were not at fault in those cases mirrors the contentious back and forth over the Justice Department's report that accused Worcester officers of using excessive force and found that some even had sexual relations with women they target-

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LEWIS JOLY/ASSOCIATED PRESS

"I think of the victims, unrecognized, whose stories often remain hidden," Gisèle Pelicot said. "I want you to know that we share the same struggle."

## By going public with rapes, woman opens doors in France

50 men lured by her husband found guilty; he gets 20 years in prison

By Catherine Porter and Ségolène Le Stradic  
NEW YORK TIMES

AVIGNON, France — In a packed courtroom, the head judge asked each of the dozens of men accused of raping Gisèle Pelicot — while she was nearly comatose, and at the invitation of her husband of 50 years — to stand briefly. Then he pronounced their convictions swiftly, one after the other: all guilty.

By the time it was over, every one of the 51 accused men had been convicted, most of them for raping Pelicot in her own bedroom. Her husband, Dominique Pelicot, 72, who had admitted to drugging her over nearly a decade to abuse her, was the only one to get the

maximum sentence of 20 years.

The rest were given sentences mostly ranging from six to nine years.

And with that, the trial that has both horrified and captivated France for almost four months ended with a victory for the woman at its center, Pelicot. She became a feminist icon for her bravery in allowing the case to be tried publicly to more fully expose the horrors of rape in a country where #MeToo hardly gained traction.

After it was over, she stepped out into a swarm of French and international reporters and hundreds of supporters who held up signs of

**RAPES, Page A4**

**Governor Maura Healey took a step aimed at alleviating the state's child care crisis,** calling for increased reimbursement for providers serving poor children. **B1.**

**Georgia's Court of Appeals disqualified the Atlanta prosecutor** who brought an election interference case against Donald Trump. **A2.**

**Dealing with drones poses a number of challenges,** and no, you're not allowed to shoot them down, writes Hiawatha Bray. **B5.**

**Syrians going back home by the thousands were shocked** by the devastation that greeted them. **A3.**

**The opening of Lovestruck Books, Harvard Square's new romance bookstore, reflects the increasing popularity** of the genre. **G1.**

## As shutdown looms, it's back to square one

GOP unable to pass Trump-approved bill that would suspend debt limit for two years

By Catie Edmondson  
NEW YORK TIMES

WASHINGTON — The government lurched toward a shutdown after the House on Thursday rejected a hastily produced plan ordered up by President-elect Donald Trump to keep funding flowing, with dozens of Republicans defying his demand to pair the spending with a two-year suspension of the federal debt limit.

The vote sent Speaker Mike Johnson back to the drawing board before a Friday night deadline with no clear path to keeping the government open.

Right-wing lawmakers balked at increasing the government's borrowing limit, something many of them have long pledged not to do without spending cuts to keep the debt from ballooning

any further.

They were joined by Democrats who savaged the GOP for bowing to Trump and reneging on a spending compromise Johnson had reached with them only days earlier.

The vote was 235-174, with one member voting "present." Thirty-eight Republicans joined almost every Democrat in voting "no."

It was an epic meltdown that reflected the deep divisions among Republicans in Congress and a fraught dynamic between them and Trump that portends a difficult road ahead in January, when the GOP will hold full control of Congress and he will be back in the White House. In particular, it suggested that the president-elect's ambitious fiscal

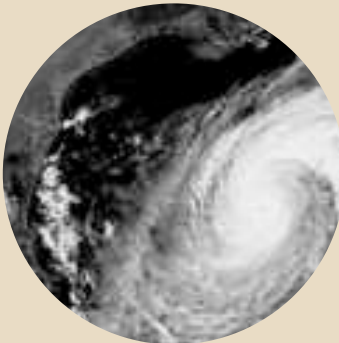
**SHUTDOWN, Page A6**

### FUNDING AT RISK OF A GOVERNMENT SHUTDOWN



**\$8 billion**  
**HIGHWAY REPAIRS**

Includes rebuilding the collapsed Francis Scott Key Bridge in Baltimore.



**\$100.4 billion**  
**DISASTER AID**

Assistance for victims of Hurricanes Helene and Milton and other natural disasters.



**\$10 billion**  
**FARM RELIEF**

Aid for farmers struggling with high costs and low prices for their products.

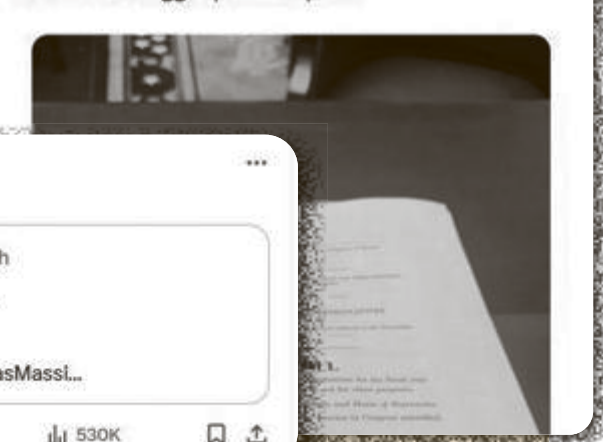


Elon Musk • X @elonmusk • 3m  
No bills should be passed Congress until Jan 20, when @realDonaldTrump takes office.

None.  
Zero.

764 1.4K 7

Elon Musk • @elonmusk  
Ever seen a bigger piece of pork?



Elon Musk • @elonmusk • 19m  
YES  
Wall Street Mav • @WallStreetMav • 5h  
Just close down the govt until January 20th. Defund everything.  
We will be fine for 33 days. x.com/RepThomasMassi...

700 1.4K 8.2K 530K

## Musk gives a taste of what power really means

By Jim Puzzanghera  
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — A political adage says the nation can only have one president at a time. But right now, the United States seems to have three of them: a lame duck, a president-elect, and the world's richest person.

President Biden is on his way out. Donald Trump is already acting like he's in charge even though he won't take office until Jan. 20. And then there's Elon Musk, Trump's mega-billionaire supporter and government-efficiency adviser, who lit the social media fuse this week that helped detonate a carefully negotiated, 1,500-page bipartisan spending bill and put the nation on the brink of a federal government shutdown as the holidays ap-

proach.

Angry Democrats already are calling him President Musk. A few Republicans even floated the idea he be the next House speaker (legally possible but far-fetched). And shell-shocked Washington lawmakers on both sides of the aisle were grappling Thursday with the likelihood that Musk will wield significant power and influence in the Trump administration — possibly amplifying Trump's impulses that already tend to cause tumult in the Capitol.

"I don't actually think Donald Trump blew this up," Senator Chris Murphy, a Connecticut Democrat, said of the short-term budget deal. "Elon Musk and his billion-

**MUSK, Page A6**

PHOTOS BY BLOOMBERG, ASSOCIATED PRESS

## In suit, CVS workers report dangerous understaffing

By Christopher Gavin  
GLOBE STAFF

PROVIDENCE — Pharmacies operating on "skeleton crews." A barrage of "endless tasks," while failing to provide employees with "basic human rights, such as going to the bathroom."

Those are just some of the hundreds of complaints from pharmacists and employees that

CVS executives repeatedly ignored, according to federal prosecutors, who in a lawsuit unsealed Wednesday alleged the Woonsocket, R.I.-based chain unlawfully dispensed opioids and other controlled substances for more than a decade.

The heart of the complaints from employees is severe understaffing that, especially when

combined with corporate performance benchmarks, decimated working conditions at locations across the country. Staffers feared the conditions jeopardized patient safety and warned that, at worst, they could prove fatal.

"Endless tasks demanded of [pharmacists] at CVS make it nearly impossible to assist pa-

tients the way they deserve and increases the possibility of catastrophic errors," one pharmacist said, according to the federal lawsuit, which accused the company of helping to fuel the nation's opioid crisis while seeking reimbursement from federal health care programs.

In their lawsuit, prosecutors

**CVS, Page A7**



### Shovel ready

**Friday:** Some snow, colder. High 35-40. Low 26-31.

**Saturday:** Flurries, icy. High 29-34. Low 13-18.

High tide: 2:35 a.m., 2:43 p.m.  
Sunrise: 7:10 Sunset: 4:14

**Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C9.**

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